

Project: ACE-IT

Assisting Childhood Education through Increased Testing

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School districts and health organizations across southeast Pennsylvania are committed to keeping staff and students healthy and safe during the COVID-19 pandemic. That's the basis of Project: ACE-IT (Assisting Childhood Education through Increased Testing), a collaborative regional effort offering in-school, rapid COVID-19



testing for children and staff who become sick during the school day and weekly testing for staff and high-risk students, voluntarily and free of charge.

This document offers information on the tests and testing program. If you have additional questions, you may contact Maggie Eisen: eisenm@chop.edu.

What COVID-19 tests are being used in this program and why?

This program primarily uses [BinaxNOW™ tests](#), which provide results in 15 minutes and are administered using a nasal swab in the *front area* of the nostril. These [antigen](#) tests are highly accurate, detecting 97%-98% of symptomatic individuals. If the person tested receives an unexpected result—meaning they are symptomatic but receive a negative result, or they are asymptomatic and receive a positive result—they may be referred for another more sensitive test, such as the [Cue Health](#), or a molecular test, such as a PCR. Referrals for additional testing



will be communicated promptly to staff members or parents/guardians of students who have tested positive. For more information on different types of COVID-19 tests, click [here](#).

Who will be tested and when?

Each school district will determine the testing model works best—including who administers

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the tests—for their students and staff, using the strongest public health guidance available. Local health departments will be instrumental in supporting this process. Project: ACE-IT's current [allotment of tests](#) provide for: 1) symptomatic testing of students and staff, and 2) weekly asymptomatic or *assurance* testing of staff and limited groups of students between January and April 2021. All testing will be limited to students and staff who are participating in in-person education.



If I (or my student) feel sick, can I (they) come to the school to be tested?

No staff or students are allowed to enter a school building if they have been exposed to COVID-19 or have [symptoms consistent with COVID-19](#). Instead, a referral to another testing location may be offered. This safety protocol is critical to the safety of the school community. In-school testing will only be available to staff and students who come to school feeling healthy, but begin to feel symptomatic during the school day.



How will I learn about my (my child's) test results, and how will this information be used?

Each school will decide how best to communicate with parents/guardians about their student if they become symptomatic and are tested—with a guardian's consent—during the school day. Staff and families of students tested will receive results via text or email shortly after they are known. All test results will be shared with the local health department as required for public health reporting and contact tracing, as well as to determine the stay-at-home period for those testing positive. School staff will also be able to quickly isolate when a student or staff member tests positive. All data will be protected and transferred via a secure server.

What happens next?

Each participating school will share their testing plans with their student and staff communities, including how to register. Please direct questions about local programming to your school, district, or county health department.